Activity A8 - Close Corrective Action and Plan the 2026 Transition

Course: Fundamentals of ISO 14001 Environmental Management System (EMS) (TGS-2023037592) Ability: A7, A8 Objective: Document nonconformity, root cause, corrective action, effectiveness and controlled improvement. Mode: Team analysis with individual evidence submission Suggested time: 60 minutes

Scenario

The tabletop showed that drain isolation ownership was unclear and contractor contact data was obsolete. Leadership also needs a structured gap review for the 2026 edition, including value-chain oversight and planned change.

Meridian EcoPack Pte Ltd (MEP) is a fictional Singapore SME with 120 employees producing printed corrugated and fibre-based packaging for regional food, electronics and healthcare customers. Two key customers require evidence of an ISO 14001:2026-aligned EMS and stronger value-chain environmental controls before contract renewal.

Task and expected output

Close the spill-response weakness and convert ISO 14001:2026 gaps into a prioritised transition roadmap.

Produce: An NCR/CAPA record, effectiveness review, continual-improvement report and controlled transition plan.

Before you begin

- Open a working copy of the Excel workbook; do not overwrite the supplied evidence.
- Allocate a facilitator, evidence recorder, checker and presenter.
- Read every evidence card before making a compliance or significance conclusion.
- If the activity concerns an incident, this is a tabletop exercise: do not handle chemicals or simulate unsafe physical actions.

Decision questions

1. What is the immediate correction, what is the verified systemic cause and what similar risks exist elsewhere?
2. Which measures will demonstrate that the action remains effective after enough evidence has accumulated?
3. Which 2026 changes affect MEP's EMS, and how will the transition avoid disrupting current controls?

Detailed procedure

Step 1 - Record the nonconformity, requirement/criterion, objective evidence, affected scope and immediate correction

Record the nonconformity, requirement/criterion, objective evidence, affected scope and immediate correction.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 2 - Contain the risk and evaluate whether the issue exists in other shifts, drains, chemicals or contractor arrangements

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Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 3 - Analyse cause using 5 Whys and barrier analysis; validate the selected root/system cause with evidence

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Step 4 - Assign corrective actions to causes with owners, resources, dates and controlled-document/competence updates

Assign corrective actions to causes with owners, resources, dates and controlled-document/competence updates.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 5 - Define effectiveness measures, sample size, review window and closure authority before implementation

Define effectiveness measures, sample size, review window and closure authority before implementation.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 6 - Complete the ISO 14001:2026 gap matrix covering context, leadership, risks/opportunities, planned change, value-chain controls, emergencies, audit objectives and management-review results

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Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 7 - Prioritise transition actions by environmental/compliance risk, dependency and readiness; present decisions required to management

Prioritise transition actions by environmental/compliance risk, dependency and readiness; present decisions required to management.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Step 8 - Document results, residual risks, lessons learned and the next review in the continual-improvement report

Document results, residual risks, lessons learned and the next review in the continual-improvement report.

Record the evidence used, the decision made, the responsible owner and any uncertainty in the workbook.

Evidence to submit

- Completed Activity-A8-Workbook.xlsx.
- One evidence-backed team decision and one documented peer challenge.
- Any assumption or missing source clearly labelled for follow-up.

Acceptance checklist

[ ] Actions address verified causes, transition priorities are traceable to current requirements, effectiveness is measured after an appropriate interval, and a reviewer can reconstruct decisions, ownership, evidence and residual risk.

[ ] Claims are traceable to supplied or cited evidence.

[ ] Assumptions, uncertainty and missing evidence are labelled.

[ ] Owners, due dates and next decisions are included where applicable.

[ ] Legal/compliance interpretations needing competent advice are escalated rather than guessed.

[ ] A peer challenge and response are recorded.

Troubleshooting

- The team cannot agree on a score: return to the criterion anchors and record each evidence-based assumption before averaging or escalating.
- Evidence is missing: do not invent it; record an evidence gap, risk implication, owner and retrieval action.
- A legal requirement is unclear: record the current authoritative source and escalate to a competent adviser or authority channel.
- A conclusion feels obvious: test an alternative explanation and state what evidence would falsify the current view.

Facilitator debrief

Ask each team to defend one priority, control or conclusion using objective evidence. Probe what would change the decision, then connect the work to PDCA and the relevant EMS process rather than clause memorisation.

Files in this activity pack

- README.md and README.pdf - detailed learner procedure.
- Activity-A8-Scenario-and-Checklist.pdf - printable scenario and completion checklist.
- Activity-A8-Workbook.xlsx - editable analysis and submission workbook.

Source and usage note

This fictional training activity paraphrases ISO 14001 concepts and is not legal advice or a reproduction of the standard. Use the organisation's licensed ISO 14001:2026 copy and current authoritative Singapore sources for formal interpretation.